

2010 03 08 Study Session

LAKEWOOD CITY COUNCIL STUDY SESSION MINUTES

Monday, March 8, 2010
City of Lakewood
Police Station Multi-Purpose Room
9401 Lakewood Drive SW
Lakewood, WA 98499

CALL TO ORDER

Mayor Richardson called the meeting to order at 7:03 p.m.

ROLL CALL

Councilmembers Present: 7 – Mayor Douglas Richardson; Deputy Mayor Don Anderson; Councilmembers Mary Moss, Mike Brandstetter, Jason Whalen, Walter Neary and Claudia Thomas.

Lakewood Fire Commissioners Present: - Waylin McCurley, Chair; Warren “Ted” Wier, Vice-Chair; Bonnie Boyle, John Clancy.

Absent: Bart Dalton.

ITEM FOR DISCUSSION:

Joint meeting with the Lakewood Fire District Commissioners.

Mayor Richardson introduced members of the Council. Fire Commissioner Chair Waylin McCurley introduced members of the Lakewood Fire Commissioners.

Lakewood Fire Chief Ken Sharp introduced members of the Fire District staff.

City Manager Neiditz and Fire Chief Ken Sharp commented on the City’s working relations between the City and the Fire District and reviewed services that the City and Fire District partner in.

Councilmember Moss asked if coordination has been made with the Joint Base Lewis-McChord for fire services. Councilmember Neary spoke about to what extent an emergency drill can be orchestrated to learn from the exercise should an actual emergency arise.

Chair McCurley provided an overview of the University Place and Lakewood fire districts merger. He then called upon University Place Fire Chief Sagers who reviewed the options the Regionalization Organization Committee studied.

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Fire Chief Ken Sharp then reviewed the timelines and process for the merger calling for a special election in February or April 2011 for Lakewood citizens to vote on the merger. He then reviewed the enhancements that would be realized from the merger which includes a savings of \$860,000 in taxpayer taxes.

Discussion ensued on how existing fire bonds would be impacted with the merger; what will be the status of service to Dupont as a result of the merger; would the merger have any changes in the fire ratings for home insurance premiums; how would fire marshal services be impacted with the City and what are the differences with another contract for services; what is the cost of the election and will the Fire District be paying for the election; how does the election of Commissioners work with the merger; will there be a Lakewood citizens campaign committee for the merger; what is the average savings per household (approximately 14 cents per \$1,000 assessed value); how many calls for service does each District respond to (10,000 for Lakewood, 3,500 for University Place); is Arrowhead and Partridge Glen area included in the merger (Yes); and what was the sentiment of the University Place public meetings.

Chair McCurley indicated that the overall sentiment was positive.

Assistant Chief Jim Sharp reviewed a proposal to consolidate Public Safety Answering Points in Lakewood and Tacoma to handle all 9-1-1 calls in Pierce County by co-locating their communications facilities by January 2013 with a long term goal to be fully consolidated by January 2015.

Discussion ensued on what Lakewood can do to co-locate the communication facilities in Lakewood; describing the sales tax increase of 1/10 of one percent sales tax to fund 9-1-1 communications; and is there a proportionate structure between police and fire 9-1-1 calls.

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Speaking before the Council was:

Dennis Haugen, Lakewood resident, spoke about the lowering of the quality of service and attitude when an organization gets too large.

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Mayor Richardson asked what the Fire District provided in the maintenance of fire hydrants. Chief Sharp indicated that the Fire District does minimal fire hydrant maintenance. Caps on the fire hydrants are checked and any needed repairs are reported to the Lakewood Water District.

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Council recessed at 8:20 p.m. and reconvened at 8:32 p.m.

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BRIEFING BY THE CITY MANAGER

Review of proposed increase of membership on the Landmarks and Heritage Advisory Board.

City Manager Neiditz provided a summary on the proposed increase of membership on the Landmarks and Heritage Advisory Board (LHAB).

Councilmember Neary commented on the LHAB's desire to increase the number of members from seven to nine. He then spoke about removing the requirement for term limits.

Discussion ensued on meeting the requirement for the mix of professionals serving on the LHAB; and if there could be concerns about meeting the requirements for a quorum by increasing the membership. Staff was requested to research if the emeritus position was a voting or non-voting member; possibly making it non-voting or increasing the Board by one instead of two positions.

Council requested that this item be brought back for further consideration in two weeks.

ITEMS TENTATIVELY SCHEDULED FOR THE MARCH 15, 2010 REGULAR CITY COUNCIL MEETING:

1. Pierce Transit System Re-Design Update. – *Ms. Tina Lee, Principal Planner, Pierce Transit*
1. Setting Monday, April 19, 2010, at approximately 7:00 p.m., as the date for a public hearing by the City Council on the Five Year FY 2010-2015 Consolidated Plan, FY 2010 Annual Action Plan and FY 2007 and FY 2008 Consolidated Plan amendments for CDBG and HOME. – (Resolution – Consent Agenda)
3. Amending the Municipal Code relative to the International Building Codes. – (Ordinance – Regular Agenda)

CITY COUNCIL COMMENTS

Councilmember Moss commented on the Black Tie and Blue Jean event over the weekend and announced that \$35,000 was raised.

Councilmember Moss commented on the Planning Advisory Board meeting she attended and their discussion regarding the Tillicum Plan. She reported that the Board elected Jeff Brown as Chair and Don Daniels as Co-Chair.

Councilmember Thomas commented on the Association of Washington Cities article about Jeff Brewster.

Councilmember Thomas announced that she will be attending the Pierce Transit Board retreat this Friday, March 12, 2010.

Councilmember Whalen commented on the Economic Development Board meeting of the Puget Sound Regional Council and the Black Tie and Blue Jean event he attended.

Deputy Mayor Anderson commented on the Black Tie and Blue Jean event he attended. He asked what the cost differential was for renting portable restrooms and possible savings versus having permanent restrooms.

Mayor Richardson commented on the radio communication system and Council's wise decision to move toward the 800Mhz radio system.

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Executive Session

Mayor Richardson announced that Council will recess into Executive Session for approximately 50 minutes to discuss pending litigation and the performance of a public official.

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Council recessed into Executive Session at 9:00 p.m. and reconvened at 9:50 p.m. At 9:50 p.m., Mayor Richardson announced that Executive Session would be extended an additional 20 minutes. At 10:10 p.m., Mayor Richardson announced that Executive Session would be extended an additional ten minutes. At 10:20 p.m., Mayor Richardson announced that Executive Session would be extended an additional ten minutes. Council reconvened at 10:30 p.m.

ADJOURNMENT

There being no further business, the meeting adjourned at 10:30 p.m.

DOUGLAS G. RICHARDSON, MAYOR

ATTEST:

ALICE M. BUSH, MMC

CITY CLERK